REISS FAMILY RECIPES

Reiss Stuffed Cabbage

MEAT ✓ LEFTOVERS

Prep **1 hr 30 min** Cook **5 hr** Total **6 hr 30 min** Serves **10**



Ingredients

Leaves & Onions

- **3** medium cabbage heads
- **4** onions — chopped and fried, divided between filling and pot
- **less than 1/4 cup** frying oil

Meat Filling

- **2 lb** ground beef
- **1 lb** ground veal (or lamb, turkey, or chicken)
- **1 cup** Carolina extra long grain white rice — measured dry
- **1/4 cup** water — cold
- **2** fried onions — half of the prepared onions
- **2** eggs
- **scant 1/4 cup** sugar

Ingredients continue →

Instructions

1. Freeze the 3 medium cabbage heads for about 3 days, then transfer to a tray or bowl in the refrigerator to thaw for 24 hours or more, until completely thawed and the leaves separate easily.
2. Separate the leaves and discard dirty or damaged leaves and the very green outer leaves; prefer the pale inner leaves for rolling. Squeeze out excess liquid. Shave down the thick, fibrous rib at the bottom center of each rolling leaf so it is thinner and more flexible, without cutting through the leaf.
3. Chop and fry the 4 onions in the oil, then divide equally between the filling and the pot; let the filling onions cool. Gently combine the beef, ground veal, dry rice, 1/4 cup cold water, 2 fried onions, eggs, sugar, honey, 2-3 tbsp tomato sauce, honey Dijon, sriracha, salt, white pepper, onion powder, and garlic powder. Mix only until evenly combined; do not knead into a smooth paste.
4. Place filling on a prepared leaf, fold the sides over it, and roll closed. Keep the rolls reasonably similar in size.
5. Reserve enough good whole leaves for about 22-24 rolls. Chop all remaining usable cabbage for the pot. Once the leaves are all prepared, finish rolling the remaining filling before constructing the pot.

Instructions continue →

Ingredients (continued)

Meat Filling

- **scant 1/4 cup** honey
- **2-3 tbsp** tomato sauce — separate, not from the pot sauce cans
- **2 tbsp** honey Dijon mustard
- **2 tbsp** sriracha
- **3 1/4 tsp** salt
- **to taste** white pepper, onion powder, and garlic powder

Pot & Sauce

- remaining usable cabbage — chopped
- **1 jar** sauerkraut (32 oz) — include all liquid
- **2** fried onions — the other half of the prepared onions
- **1-2** marrow bones
- **1 1/3 cup** sugar (slightly less than 1 1/2 cups)
- **2 can** tomato sauce (28 oz cans)
- **about 1 1/2 can** water — use the emptied sauce cans
- **1-2 tbsp** spicy brown mustard
- **1 1/2 tbsp** salt
- **to taste** black pepper

Instructions (continued)

6. Build three layers: start each layer with chopped cabbage and sauerkraut plus its liquid, add rolls, then add a third of the sauce ingredients, water, sugar, and seasonings. Place one marrow bone at the bottom and the second in the middle layer, if using.
7. Bring the pot to a simmer, cover, and cook gently for 3-5 hours, starting to check at 3-3 1/2 hours. Check the meat with a thermometer in the center of a large roll: at least 160°F for beef, veal, or lamb, or at least 165°F for turkey or chicken; check more than one roll. Split a roll open to confirm the rice is fully soft without a hard center and the cabbage is tender, then taste and adjust seasoning.

Tips

- **Plan ahead:** Freeze the cabbage heads for about 3 days, then thaw in the refrigerator for 24 hours or more before cooking day.
- **Do not pack the filling:** Mix the meat and rice only until evenly combined - overworking the filling makes it dense.
- **Check doneness:** Check a large roll with a thermometer: 160°F for beef, veal, or lamb, 165°F for turkey or chicken. Split a roll to confirm the rice is soft and the cabbage is tender.

Plan ahead: freeze the cabbage about 3 days, then thaw 24 hours or more in the refrigerator. 'Scant' means slightly less than stated. The 1/4 cup filling water is a new addition; the cooked-rice option is untested in this recipe. Yield and cooking time are approximate. — From the family kitchen (Josh Reiss)